



Daystar University
May- July 2026 Trimester
Theology of Work and Development
THEO 401A

* Date: Monday 24th May 2026

Devotion: Daniel 3:15-28

Jesus is the Answer

1. Daniel's courageous three friends were truly on the hot seat. King Nebuchadnezzar threatened to throw them into a blazing furnace if they did not worship his idol.
2. He asked "What god will rescue you from my hand?" (Dan.3:15) but the friends still refused to bow, so the king heated the furnace seven times hotter and had them tossed in.
3. They didn't go alone, an Angel (vs 28), perhaps Jesus himself, joined them in the fire, keeping them from harm and providing an undeniable answer to the king's question (vs 24-25)
4. Nebuchadnezzar praised the "God of Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego" and conceded that "no other god can save in this way"(vs28-29).
5. At times we may feel in over our heads. But Jesus stands with those who serve Him. He will carry us.

Lesson 2: Biblical Foundations of Work: Genesis and Beyond

Lecture Objectives

1. Explore the biblical view of work starting from Genesis
2. Understand the theological significance of work in Scripture
3. Examine key biblical themes related to human labor and purpose
4. Connect biblical foundations to contemporary understandings of work

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Introduction

1. Work as a central aspect of human life in biblical theology
2. The Bible offers insights into the divine purpose of work and human vocation
3. Biblical narratives shape ethical and spiritual perspectives on labor

Genesis 1-2: The Creation of Humanity and Work

1. Genesis 1:26-28: Humanity created in God's image
2. "Let us make mankind in our image..."
3. Genesis 2:15: The man's first task — tending and keeping the Garden of Eden
4. "The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it."
5. Key Point: Work is part of human identity from the beginning; it is rooted in divine intention

The Imago Dei and Human Dignity

1. Imago Dei (Image of God): Humanity reflects God's creative, relational, and purposeful nature
2. Implication for Work: Work affirms human dignity and purpose
3. "Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord." (Colossians 3:23)

The Goodness of Work in Genesis

1. Work is described as "good" (Genesis 1:31)
2. It is part of God's original plan for human flourishing and stewardship
3. Stewardship: Caring for creation reflects divine authority and responsibility

The Fall and Its Impact on Work

1. Genesis 3: The entrance of sin corrupts work
2. Consequences:
 - Thorns and thistles in the ground (Genesis 3:17-19)

- Pain and toil in labor
- Struggle and frustration
- Key Reflection: While work remains essential, it is marred by sin and brokenness

Beyond Genesis — Biblical Themes of Work

- * Justice and Fairness: The prophets emphasize social justice (e.g., Isaiah 58:6-7)
- * Restoration: Hope for renewal and redemption in work and society
- * Vocation: Work as calling, service, and participation in God's mission

Biblical Examples of Work and Vocation

- * Bezalel and Oholiab (Exodus 31): Skilled artisans chosen by God for sacred craftsmanship
- * The Proverbs: Wisdom in work and diligent effort (Proverbs 10:4, 22:29)
- * Jesus as a Carpenter: Work as a form of service and humility (Mark 6:3)

Key Observations

- * Work is rooted in God's original creation plan
- * Humanity's dignity is linked to being made in God's image
- * Work is both a divine gift and a responsibility
- * The fall introduces hardship, but hope for renewal remains central

Group After class Discussions and Presentations

- * How does Genesis inform your understanding of work today?
- * In what ways does the biblical view of work challenge modern attitudes?
- * How can biblical principles guide ethical work and development?